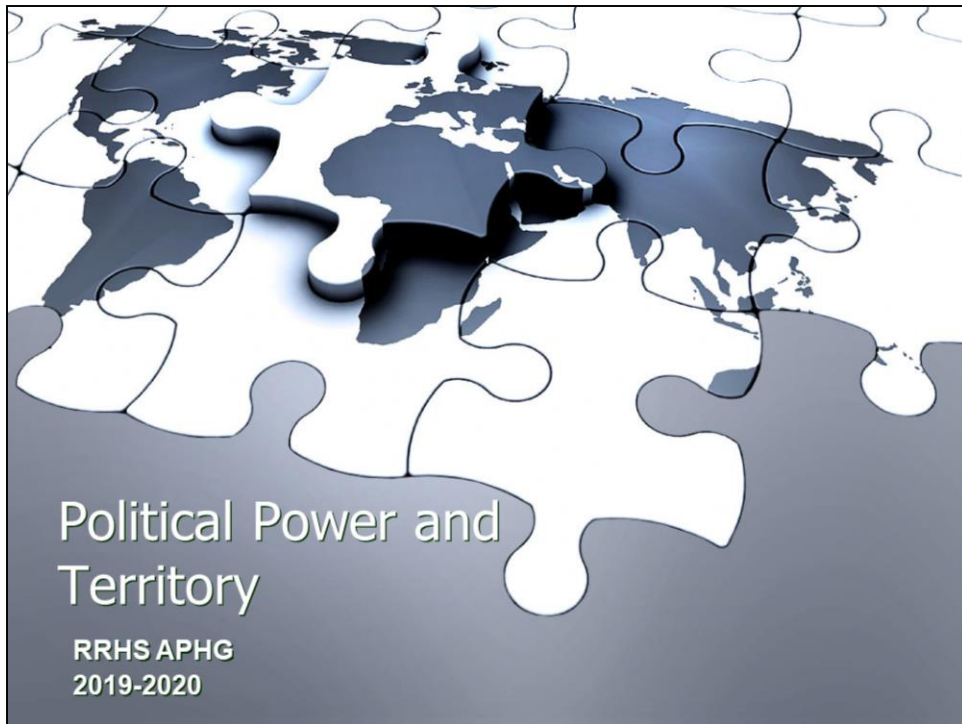






Political Power

- Legitimacy + Authority = power



In government, authority is often used interchangeably with power. However, their meanings differ: while power is the ability to order or accomplish a goal or to influence others, authority refers to a claim of legitimacy, the justification and right to exercise that power.

Control Over People

- Authority to govern
 - Participatory governments
 - Democracy
 - Republic
 - Constitutional monarchy
 - Authoritative governments
 - Dictatorship
 - Totalitarian dictatorship
 - Absolute monarchy



In Western culture, the idea of the people granting the government the authority to have power is a fundamental part of the government structure. This concept dates back to the democracies of the early city-states (Rome, Athens, etc.), which collapsed prior to the dark ages (feudal period of Europe). As the people of Europe demanded more participatory governments (where the people are citizens rather than subjects) in the 1700s and 1800s, this concept formed a central part of the ideals upon which the new governments were created.

These ideas began diffusing around the world as former colonies gained their independence from their former colonizers (1776 with the U.S. through today). The Declaration of Independence (sent by the rebelling American colonist to King George in 1776) includes the line “Governments are instituted among Men, deriving their just powers from the consent of the governed, --That whenever any Form of Government becomes destructive of these ends, it is the Right of the People to alter or to abolish it, and to institute new Government” – this means that in the United States, it is understood that the government of the state is created by the people and has the authority to govern because the people say it does. If the government at some point begins to work against the people, it will lose their consent, be abolished, and rebuilt as needed.

Participatory governments – the people participate in the operations of the state through voting

Democracy - majority rules – the people vote either directly or they elect representatives to vote on their behalf)

Republics - (representatives are chosen by the people to vote on their behalf. Majority votes decide major legislation, but minority rights are protected by a Constitution (The United States is a Republic).

Constitutional monarchy – the monarch is a figurehead and a diplomat (foreign relations), but the head of government is elected (i.e., the U.K., Denmark)

Authoritative governments – power rests with one individual or a small group of individuals

Dictatorship – rises to power through force (often violent or a coup d'état*) – (example, Iraq under Saddam Hussein, Cuba under Fidel Castro)

Totalitarian dictatorship – the dictator (and advisors) control all aspects of life within the state – politics, economics, culture, etc. (example: North Korea)

Absolute monarchy – hereditary right to power (born into the crown), functions as a dictatorship (example, Saudi Arabia)

*a coup d'état is the overthrow of an existing government by non-democratic means; typically, it is an illegal, unconstitutional seizure of power by a dictator, the military, or a political faction

Control over land, water, and resources



Control over territory also means control over the resources located on that territory – this means minerals, metals, fertile soil, water, fish, etc.

The map above shows the competing claims to the South China Sea – many states claim rights to the water and resources located within (more on this conflict later this unit).



Examples of Political Power

- Sovereignty and independent states
- Neocolonialism
- Shatterbelts
- Chokepoints

Sovereignty and independent states



The idea of sovereignty was introduced and defined with the Treaty of Westphalia in 1648 and has already been discussed at length in the “political patterns and processes” notes. It was reinforced with the French Revolution, at which time the idea of the **“nation-state”** truly began to form. The idea out of the French Revolution (1789 – so just one decade after the American Revolution) started with the “Declaration of the Rights of Man” in 1789. It was “The principle that all sovereignty resides essentially in the nation; no body or individual may exercise any authority that does not proceed directly from the nation”.

In short, the major political concepts that came out of the French Revolution (1789) included the idea that consent to govern should come from the **nation** itself, and that the boundaries of the nation should define the boundaries of the state.

Today, there are about 200 sovereign states today – it’s “about” because there are 195 United Nations-recognized states and some others that claim to be independent states but the UN does not recognize their sovereignty, such as Taiwan.

Neocolonialism

- Pseudo-control of other states, especially former colonies
 - Economic dependent
 - Political protectorates



Neocolonialism is the use of economic, political, cultural, or other pressures to control or influence other countries, especially former dependencies (colonies). These former colonies are now independent states, but are economically dependent on their former colonizers for trade or politically as a military dependency, which means the former colonies depend on their former colonizers for military protection from other states.

Shatterbelts

- Area that lies between two powerful spheres of influence (i.e., the “West” and the “East”)
 - **Conflict zone**
 - **Satellite states**



Despite the concept of sovereignty, many states often fall under the influence of more powerful states. These more powerful states are called “superpowers”, and for much of the 20th century the world’s two superpowers were the USSR and the USA. These countries had conflicting views of how governments and economics should operate – The “West” (USA and Western Europe) was pro-democracy/republic and free-enterprise economics while the East (USSR and Eastern Europe) was pro-authoritative government (communist) and command economy (where the government has complete control over the economic system and social services of the state).

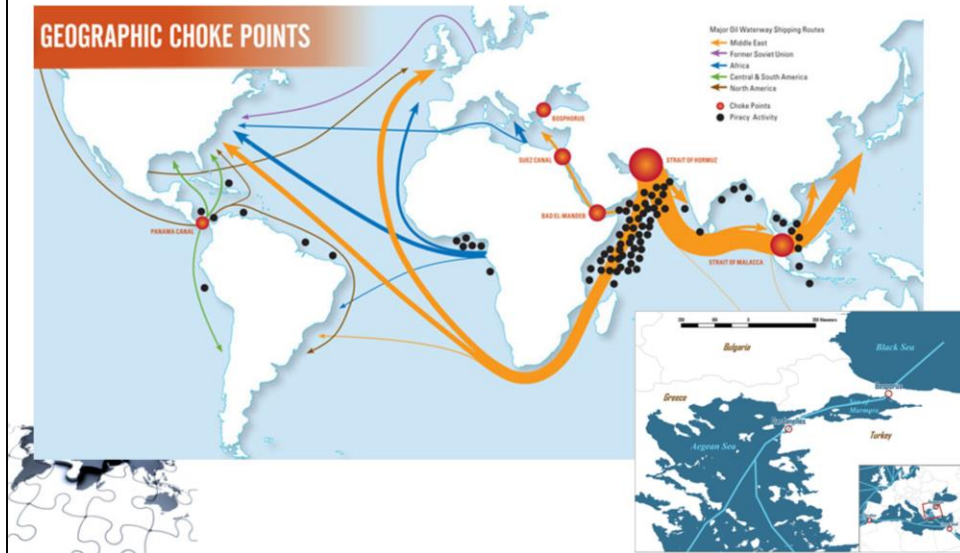
A **satellite state** is a country that is formally independent in the world, but under heavy political, economic and military influence or control from another country. The Soviet Satellite states of Eastern Europe (such as Romania, Czechoslovakia, Poland, etc.) were also communist and had Soviet supported governments. These states were located in the Shatterbelt between the Eastern and Western powers. The Balkans Peninsula is not only a shatterbelt region between the Russian Domain and the “West”, but also is heavily influenced by the Islamic realm as there are ties there from the former Ottoman Empire.

A shatterbelt is a region caught between stronger colliding external forces, under persistent stress, and often fragmented by aggressive rivals.

Southeast Asia is another shatterbelt region as the East and the West also fought for influence and control over that region of the world (with wars breaking out in Korea and Vietnam) – more on the geopolitical theories that influenced these historical conflicts later this unit.

Choke Points

- Narrow crossing that is easily controlled



A **choke point** is a narrow crossing by water (straits, canals, etc.) or by land (mountain pass) which is easily controlled from a military standpoint – control of these strategic locations can interrupt international trade or block military troops from passing through. The Suez canal (located in Egypt) was once shut down for almost a decade due to international conflict between Egypt and their allies and Israel (backed by the US and Europe). The countries who control these chokepoints are at an economic and strategic advantage in global politics. International energy flows (crude oil and natural gas) move through many of these chokepoints daily and are especially vulnerable to regional conflicts, terrorism, and piracy. The flow map above shows major oil shipping routes and how they pass through these chokepoints. The size of the line is representative of the volume of oil that moves along that line. The orange line is oil out of the Middle East, the blue is oil exported from Africa (primarily Nigeria), the green is oil from Central and South America, the purple is oil from the former Soviet Union and satellite states, and the red is oil from North America. The red dots show the major chokepoints (except for the Strait of Gibraltar). The black dots are the locations of known piracy activity.

Other Examples of chokepoints:

The Strait of Gibraltar (opening to the Mediterranean Sea from the Atlantic Ocean). Located in Spain (Europe side) and Morocco (African side), controlled by the UK.

Turkish Straights two sets of straits, the Bosphorus Straits and Dardanelles, control access to the Black Sea from the Mediterranean Sea (and therefore access to the Atlantic Ocean) for many Central Asian countries. The smaller map on the bottom right shows a “zoomed in” view of this important choke point.

Panama Canal – located in the Central American country of Panama, controlled by the US (and Panama was formerly part of Columbia, but the US backed an independence movement in Panama prior to the construction of the canal).

Bab-el-Mandeb – located at the entrance to the Red Sea from the India Ocean (between Somalia and Yemen) is under constant threat of piracy. Many ships have been taken hostage in this region in the past few decades as Somalia’s government is defunct and its former territory is a breeding ground for piracy and terrorist.

Straight of Hormuz – located between Iran and Oman at the entrance to the Arabian Sea/Persian Gulf (depending on who you ask) where the vast majority of the Middle East Oil exports must pass to be transported around the world.

Straight of Malacca – located between Indonesia and Malaysia on a major shipping route for global manufacturing (almost all East Asia or Southeast Asian nations’ manufactured exports must pass through this straight). It connects the Indian Ocean to the South China Sea and Pacific Ocean. Singapore is an Entrepot center located in this straight – it acts as a global distribution center – ships full of exports come in to Singapore where they are sorted and put onto new ships bound for different parts of the world.



Territoriality

- End of Feudal system
- Rise of modern Nation-states
- Diffusion of the European Model

The Feudal period of Europe and other parts of the world, including Japan, was a system in which a land owner (lord or Baron) is granted control over a portion of territory. In turn, the Lord or Baron has knights (an army) who protect the land, and peasants who work the land in exchange for keeping a portion of the crops for their own use (the other portion goes to the Lord, knights, and religious leaders). The Lord/Baron has to pay taxes to the King or Emperor and respect their ultimate authority.

While Japan was not a former colony of a European power, the state adopted the European model in the mid 1800s (19th century) when its feudal period ended.

Improvements in technology, growing populations, and finally the industrial revolution signaled the final death toll of the feudal system in Europe. As technology and improved transportation made global trade more profitable and lucrative (and spurred European exploration and colonization), agricultural production increased due to new food sources brought to Europe from the Americas plus new and better farming techniques were developed, and weapons became more sophisticated, the feudal system was made obsolete. To defend and protect the nations, military action had to be based on mobility.

Combined with desire to control more and more land in order to control the resources on them, the states expanded their territorial claims rather than having a frontier (open, unclaimed area) between rival kingdoms. Time-space compression due to technological advancements was a key factor here as an army could much more quickly move across larger spaces due to better modes of transportation (not just on foot), and bigger equipment (cannons) could be easily moved as well.

As mentioned a few slides ago, the concept of the modern-day Nation-state was born of the French Revolution in 1789 when the prevailing thought was that the boundaries of the state should coincide with the boundaries of the nation – this means that where the nation resides, the territory belongs to the state to which the nation has given authority to govern (this concept of the nation wanting their territory to belong to the government of their choice will be important later this unit – for both stateless nations and irredentism). The change was a slow process, however, as the centuries preceding this revolution saw the consolidation of monarchies and the decline of the role of religious leaders in politics. The French Revolution was a culminating event that marked the end of this long period of change.

Diffusion of the European Model: in the 19th century through the mid 20th century, the European powers controlled much of the world through their Empires and colonies, and therefore defined many of the “rules” of the emerging international state system (and relationships between those states). Through the 20th century as the former colonies gained independence, the idea of establishing participatory governments of the nations and for the nation (of the people, for the people) diffused around the world. This concept influenced the way newly independent states were created – for example, why India was partitioned into a Muslim state and a Hindu state. As these states were created by a transition of power from the colonizer to the newly independent former colony rather than by war, the European powers had a much more influential role in setting up the governments of their former colonies in Asia and Africa than they did their former colonies in the Americas, which had won their independence through war in the 19th century.

Connection of people and culture to the land

- Emotional ties
- Historical occupation
- Economic dependency

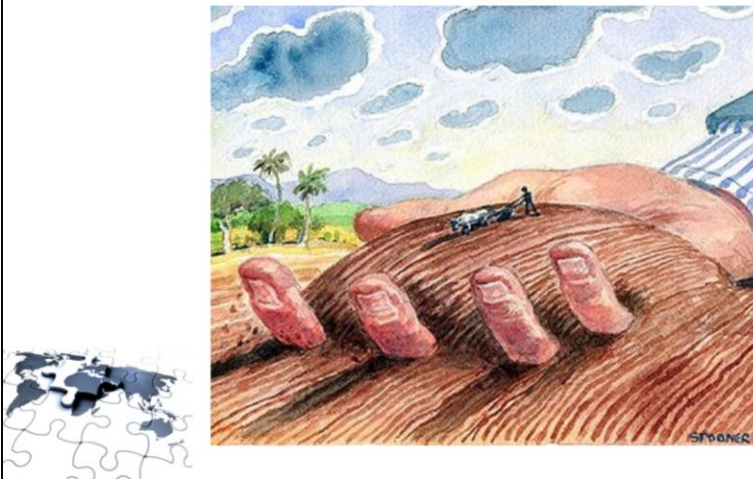


Nations are tied to the land – the group has a historical connection to it, which includes the belief that that particular piece of land belongs to that particular group of people. It is a mentifact that is embedded into the culture. In most instances, the nation has occupied that territory for a significant amount of time that the nation developed in that place. The traditional ways of life, which include customs, traditions, and economics developed as a result of the physical geographic features of that place (i.e, food preferences, farming methods, etc.). Important events in the history of the nation occurred there and are considered sacred sites. And the nation depends on the resources of the land for their economic livelihood.

Shown above is Uluru in Australia. The geologic people is of significance and sacred to the indigenous people of the continent.

Connection of economic systems to the land

- Resources
- Traditional occupations



Control of natural resources is a significant part of the concept of territoriality, especially if the nation depends on those resources for their economic viability. Raw materials that can be sold or used in manufacturing are vital to the wealth of the nation.

Imperialist powers that colonized other places took control of the land and the natural resources. Imperialism in Africa and Southeast Asia was based on the desire of the European manufacturers to develop trade monopolies with those new territories – the European powers had control over the sale and export of raw materials, and the colony was also dependent on the colonizer for imported manufactured products. The Europeans reaped the benefits of the mercantilist system and became very wealthy, which in turn allowed them to build bigger and better armies and claim additional territory. Meanwhile, the economic development of the colonized territory was stunted as almost all infrastructure development was built for the purpose of supporting the European power's export systems.

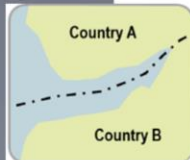
Nations practicing traditional economics (agriculture) are dependent on the land for their land as well. If there are rival nations competing for control of the same territory within a state, conflict is a likely result.



Types of Political Boundaries

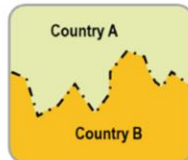
How are boundaries determined?

- Geometric
- Antecedent
- Subsequent/Consequent
- Superimposed
- relic



Antecedent

Pre-existing; commonly corresponds to a physical feature. Rivers, Bays, Lakes, Mountains.



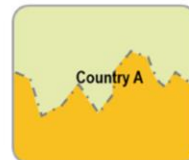
Subsequent

Set after the settlements of different groups meet. Often correspond to their respective ecumene.



Superimposed

Boundary is imposed by an outside force (treaty). May not reflect existing cultural landscape.



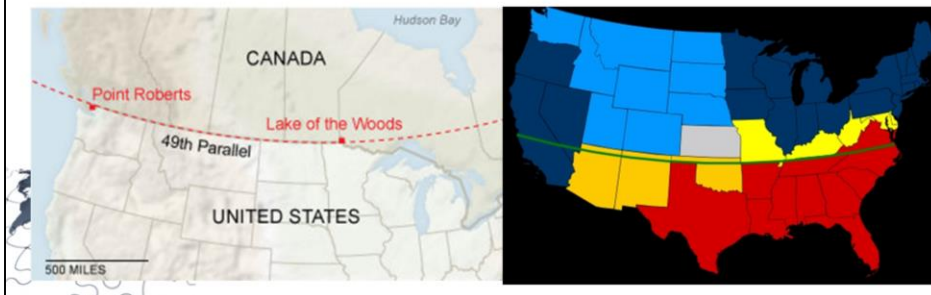
Relic

No longer a boundary. Often the outcome of political changes. Still a visible imprint on the landscape.

Boundaries can be determined in a number of ways. Sometimes they are based on latitude and longitude, other times they are drawn to match the area occupied by a nation. Still other times they are drawn based on the decisions of outside forces without regard to the existing national patterns that exist in the real world.

Geometric boundaries

- Based on latitude/longitude or other coordinate system
- Are “straight” lines on a map
 - Example: 49th parallel (northern border between US and Canada)
 - 36°30’
 - Northernmost border of Texas
 - Important line of latitude in US history



Geometric boundaries are boundaries based on a coordinate system, most commonly latitude and longitude.

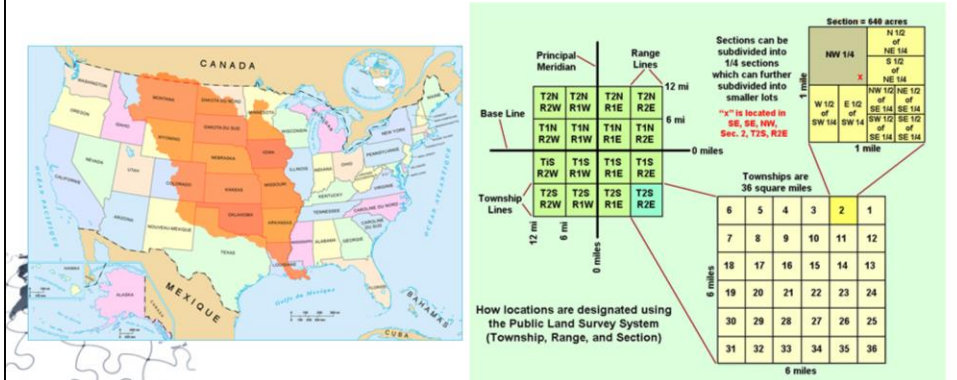
Both international borders and internal political boundaries can be drawn using this system. For example, the northern border between the US and Canada was set as 49°N latitude (also referred to as the 49th parallel, which is another way to refer to a line of latitude).

Internal political boundaries within a state can also be drawn geometrically. The 36°30' line is important in US history as it was set by the Missouri compromise. The Missouri compromise allowed for Maine to be admitted to the Union as a free state, while Missouri was added as a slave state, keeping the balance between free and slave states in the US at the time. However, there was a push to address the new territories of the western part of the continent that Mexico had ceded to the US following the Mexican-American War in 1848 that extended US-controlled territory to the Pacific Ocean (and fulfilled “Manifest Destiny” – the US Policy that sought to expand territory from the Atlantic Ocean to the Pacific Ocean). There was debate over the future statehood of these new territories – would they be admitted as “free” or “slave”? The potential to disrupt the balance of power in Congress between the

free and slave states was tense – so with the addition of Maine and Missouri to the Union, the compromise was set that territory south of $36^{\circ}30'$ would be slave, and areas north of the line of latitude would be free. This compromise was one part of many dividing decisions that eventually led the US to Civil War in 1861.

Antecedent Boundaries

- Boundaries set before an area is populated
 - **Ex: Most of the western portion of the US**
 - Mostly geometric or physical landmarks
 - Township and Range system developed to help evenly distribute populations across the area
 - Set **BEFORE** the area was settled



The prefix “ante” means “before” – so remember that these boundaries were drawn **before** the territory was settled by people. These boundaries may either be naturally-occurring boundaries (and often acted as barriers to diffusion, keeping different groups of people separate from each other allowing unique cultures to develop).

This type of boundary can also be set geometrically or using physical landscapes such as mountain ridges or rivers on unoccupied territories. The majority of the boundaries of the western half of the US were antecedent boundaries – this is why they have their distinctive box shapes. The **township and range system** was a system developed by the US government to set political boundaries as they mapped the Louisiana Territory (purchased from France in 1803) and to help evenly settle the territory to solidify the US’s claim to it, and later in the Great Basin, Pacific Northwest, and South West US as those territories as American claims expanded to reach the Pacific Ocean.

Subsequent Boundaries

- Developed “organically” as a result of a nation occupying a territory.
 - State boundaries evolve over time as the cultural landscape takes shape
 - Long process of adjustment and modification
 - Typically follow ethno-national boundaries

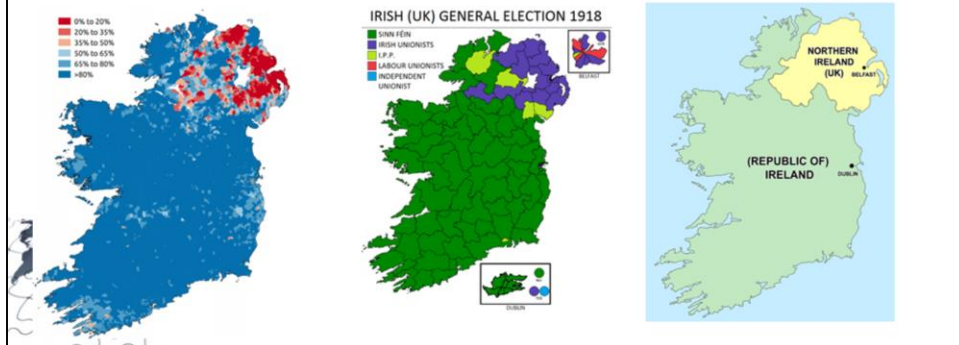


Subsequent boundaries develop “organically” (naturally) over long periods of time as the cultural landscape forms. There are adjustments and modifications that occur throughout this process as the cultural landscape and ethno-national boundaries evolve, and the boundaries typically follow the boundaries of the nation, forming a nation-state.

A good example of subsequent boundaries are the nations and territories of Great Britain – England, Scotland, and Wales.

Consequent Boundaries

- Drawn according to the existing cultural patterns already in existence
 - Example: Northern Ireland/Republic of Ireland
 - Partition of India
 - State boundaries of Europe following WWI



Consequent boundaries are drawn after an area is already populated, but take into regard the existing ethno-national/cultural patterns that exist. These boundaries are different from subsequent boundaries. Subsequent boundaries occur “organically” where there was an existing divide between states as the states’ boundaries were formalized over a long period of time, while consequent boundaries are created where no political boundary existed before. These boundaries are created as a consequence of some even – usually a war – but take into account the existing regional divides between nations or culture groups.

Examples of consequent boundaries would include the boundary between Northern Ireland and the Republic of Ireland after the Republic of Ireland won their independence from the UK. The state boundary of the newly formed state was drawn between the majority-protestant counties of the north that remained part of the UK and the boundaries of the Catholic counties that formed the Republic of Ireland. On the map above, left, the red areas show the distribution of Christian Protestants on the island of Ireland. The map in the middle shows the results a general election in 1918, and a map after the partition following the revolution and recognition of the Republic of Ireland as an independent state in 1921.

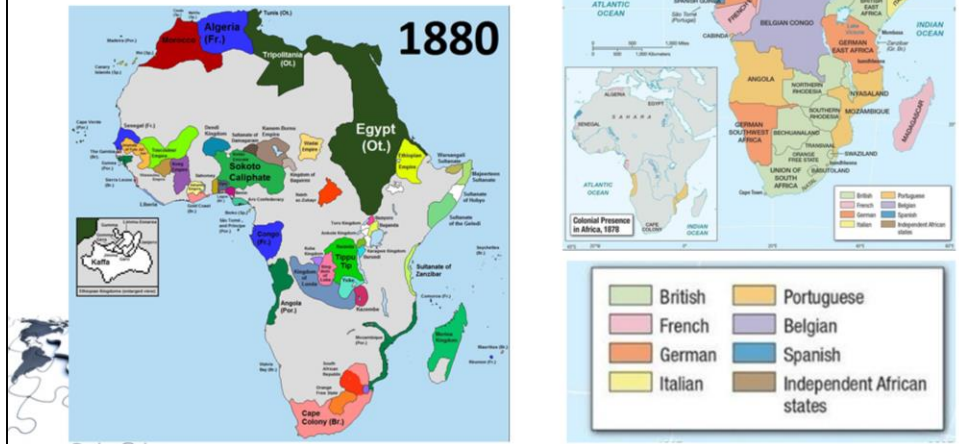
Another example of a consequent boundary was the partition of former British colony of India into India (Hindu state) and East/West Pakistan (Muslim state). East Pakistan eventually declared their own independence from Pakistan and became Bangladesh.

The state boundaries were redrawn following the collapse of the Austro-Hungarian Empire and to scale back Germany's territory following World War I. Attempts were made to have the boundaries of the states line up with the boundaries of the nations. For the western part of the continent, these consequent boundaries worked fairly well, but there was difficulty in doing so in the Balkans, with much of the territory (and many nations) being lumped together to create the multi-national state Yugoslavia.

*it is important to note that sometimes "consequent" boundaries are lumped in with "subsequent" boundaries as both are based on cultural/ethno-national patterns. The difference is in how the borders came to be.

Superimposed Boundaries

- Drawn and enforced by outside powers without regard to existing cultural/ethno-national patterns
 - Example: Scramble for Africa



The map on the left shows the existing nations of Africa prior to major European colonization – note the British territory at Cape Colony (major stop for trade routes, plus Cape of Good Hope is sometimes considered a choke point as the waters rounding the southern tip of the continent and treacherous for sailors due to converging ocean currents and many storms). European control of this Cape dates back to the 1600s as the Portuguese, Dutch, and British have all controlled it at one point in history. The Afrikkans language is a dialect of Dutch and one of the official languages of modern-day South Africa along with English. Also note the Indian Ocean states – these were developed and an important part of the Indian Ocean trade routes, dominated by Muslim (and Arab) merchants and as a result are primarily Islamic.

The map on the right shows the map of European-controlled territory in Africa following the Berlin Conference and before the outbreak of World War I (the map key for the map on the right has been enlarged to allow you to see which European powers controlled which territory – remember, following WWI, Germany was forced to give up their African holdings). The only two independent African states as of 1914 were Ethiopia and Liberia – and Liberia was set up by the US government as a place for freed slaves to return to the African continent. The boundaries for these colonial holdings were drawn without regard to the existing cultural landscape of the continent. Following

WWII when the European powers withdrew their colonial governments and the states were made independent the impact of these **superimposed** boundaries became volatile – some implications include:

Multi-national/multi-ethnic states: rival nations were forced together into the same state, with each side trying to gain control of the government (civil war and genocides have occurred due to this circumstance), nations are split across multiple states and may be isolated from one another as they are not permitted to cross those borders, some nations have gained their independence, but are now **landlocked** and at an economic and political disadvantage.

Loss of culture: these nations lost some of their cultural identity – the languages of the colonizers were often adopted as an official language as the new state and act as a lingua franca within it. This can cause a loss of the native language as it is used less frequently or seen as lower-class or less advantageous for educational, economic, or political aspirations.

Ineffective/contested governments: The governments may be ineffective as they are not seen as legitimate by a portion of the population, which can limit their ability to negotiate treaties or trade deals with other nations the other nations may prefer to work with the other groups as they may offer more favorable terms, undermining the “official” government (this goes back to recognition of states by other states. Some states have more than one government as the rival nations each set up their own government – which one is the true government? Which government do other states recognize? A similar circumstance exists with Taiwan and China – the government of Taiwan claims it is the true government of China and is in exile (more on this situation in East Asia later this unit).

Uneven development the existing colonial infrastructure and uneven development acts as a centrifugal force within these new states, especially where one group benefits more from the infrastructure than other groups.

Relic Boundaries

- Place where a boundary formerly existed

- **Examples:**

- Brandenburg Gate
- Great Wall of China
- Vietnam DMZ



Relic boundaries are the opposite of consequent boundaries – they are boundaries that used to exist but no longer do. They are typically still visible on the cultural landscape.

The Brandenburg Gate was built in the 1780s marking the entrance to the walled city of Berlin, built by Kaiser Frederick William II of Prussia. When Napoleon defeated Prussia in the early 1800s, he claimed the gate as a trophy. When Napoleon was defeated in 1814, it was reclaimed by the Prussian king, and only the royal family and those with the royal family's permission were permitted to pass through it. When the Nazis rose to power in the 1930s, they used the gate as the symbol of their political party. It was heavily damaged in WWII, but following the partition of Germany and Berlin following the war, the two governments repaired it in a joint effort, and it served as the crossing point between the two governments until the Berlin Wall was built in August 1961 and the crossing was closed. The Gate was officially reopened in 1989 as the two Germanys were reunited and the West German Chancellor (head of government, similar to the president) walked through to greet the East German Chancellor. It is now used as a symbol of freedom.

The Great Wall of China is the collective name of a series of fortification

systems generally built across the historical northern borders of China to join territories of Chinese states and empires protect them against various nomadic groups of the steppe (the Mongols) and their states. The most well-known portion of the wall was built by the Ming Dynasty about 600s years ago. The “wall” acted as a boundary between the Chinese nation(s) and the tribal nations on the Mongolian plateau.

The Vietnam DMZ (demilitarized zone) was the dividing boundary between China and Russia-backed Communist North Vietnam and US and NATO-backed democratic South Vietnam. This boundary was geometric, set on the 17th parallel. When South Vietnam fell to Communist North Vietnam, the physical markers of the DMZ became a relic boundary on the cultural landscape.